



Project Controls Institute Global, Inc.

"AI proposes. The professional disposes."

Marketing Playbook

Channels, LinkedIn outreach & the complete
ready-to-send template library

Prepared for the PCI marketing team

August 2026 · Internal working document

Companion asset: LinkedIn Launch Pack (20 posts)

*Voice rule: teach, don't hype — never claim accreditation, recognition or outcomes
PCI does not yet hold. Honesty is the brand.*

projectcontrolsinstitute.org · hello@projectcontrolsinstitute.org

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A practical working document for PCI marketing. Part 1 gives you the facts, Part 2 the market numbers, Part 3 everything the platform gives away free, Part 4 the student pitch, Part 5 the techniques per platform (LinkedIn is the priority), Part 6 the message templates — short to long, copy-paste ready — Part 7 the rebuttal library, and Part 8 the co-builder mission.

Three golden rules (apply to every message and post):

- 1. Stay honest.** Never claim accreditation, guaranteed jobs/salary, or 501(c)(3) status. PCI's candour *is* the brand. (Quick do/don't list in Part 9.)
- 2. Personalise the first line.** One sentence showing you know who they are beats any template.
- 3. One message, one ask.** Visit the site, apply, reply, or book a call — never all four.

Part 1 — The facts to memorise

Question you'll get	Answer
What is PCI?	The Project Controls Institute — an independent, non-profit certifying body for project controls, cost engineering and project finance, with governed AI built into the standard. Founded 2025. Slogan: <i>"AI proposes. The professional disposes."</i>
What does it offer?	Three professional certifications — PCL-AI (AI Project Controls Leader), PFL-AI (AI Project Finance Leader), PML-AI (Project Management Leader – AI) — plus membership, chapters in 25 countries , free resources, a Simulation Lab, webinars and a community.
Which languages?	Launching in seven languages — English, Arabic, Chinese, French, Korean, Russian and Spanish — with 15,000+ site and portal strings already translated.
Is it accredited?	Its framework is developed with reference to ISO/IEC 17024 ; PCI is building toward formal accreditation and says so plainly — it does not claim accreditation it doesn't hold.
How are exams run?	Real, proctored, scenario-based exams delivered through a locked-down secure exam client. MCQ practice is on Certuvo , PCI's official study platform; applied practice is in the Simulation Lab .
Can credentials be checked?	Yes — every credential and honorary award is publicly verifiable at projectcontrolsinstitute.org/verify.html , any time, by anyone.
Ways in?	Standard (paid, exam) · Founding (free during the founding window, exam still required) · Honorary (free, no exam — board-conferred Honorary Fellow (PCI) for distinguished contribution).
What does honorary cost?	Nothing. Ever. No application fee, no conferral fee, no membership fee, no renewal fee.
What's free?	A lot — the full free stack (Simulation Lab, templates library, books, MCQs, lectures, chapters) is in Part 3 .
What does the standard route cost?	Current published pricing (check the live membership page before quoting): membership USD 99 per 3-year term, PCL-AI exam USD 500 — launch discounts currently applied (≈ USD 49.50 and USD 350).
Key links	Site: projectcontrolsinstitute.org · Apply (honorary): /honorary-application.html · Enrol: /enrol.html · Verify: /verify.html · Contact: hello@projectcontrolsinstitute.org

Question you'll get	Answer
Social	LinkedIn: linkedin.com/company/project-control-institute · X: @projectcontrolinstitute

Part 2 — The market in numbers

Use these to answer "how big is this really?" — with employers, students and partners. **They are third-party estimates, not PCI research: always name the source, and re-check the figure before putting it in anything public.** For salary conversations, point at PCI's own salary-reports page rather than quoting numbers from memory.

Number	What it covers	Source (cite it)
25 million	New project professionals the global economy needs by 2030 — roughly 2.3 million a year	PMI, <i>Talent Gap</i> report (2021)
~90 million	People expected to be working in project-oriented roles worldwide by 2027	PMI, <i>Talent Gap</i> (2017)
~1 million	Project management specialists employed in the US alone	US Bureau of Labor Statistics
~220,000	Cost estimators employed in the US — one specialism inside project controls	US Bureau of Labor Statistics
US\$94 trillion	Global infrastructure investment needed to 2040 — every dollar of it needs planning, cost control and risk management	Oxford Economics / Global Infrastructure Hub
US\$300–500 billion/yr	Typical annual global project-finance lending volume (verify the current-year figure before use)	IJGlobal / LSEG league tables

How to use them honestly:

- Project controls is the specialism *inside* those totals: every mega-programme needs planners, cost engineers and risk analysts, and controls skills appear year after year on infrastructure skills-shortage lists in the UK, the Gulf and Australia. Demand is structural, not cyclical.
- The AI angle: the tools are automating the *production* of schedules and forecasts, which makes the person who can **validate** them more valuable, not less. That is exactly the capability PCI certifies — no other body treats governed AI as core to the discipline.
- Never convert these into promises ("you will get a job / earn X"). The honest line: *"the demand is documented; the credential is how you evidence you can meet it."*

Part 3 — What the platform gives away free

This is PCI's strongest marketing asset: a genuinely large free stack. Know it cold.

What	What it is	Who gets it free
Simulation Lab	Applied practice labs, drills and scenarios (planning, cost, EVM...) with deterministic grading, competency tracking and next-step recommendations — practice like the real work, not flashcards	Students and honorary members, per the entitlement settings
Free Templates Library	Working planning/cost artefact templates inside the Simulation Lab, mapped to the engine each template serves	Same as the Lab
Body of Knowledge & books	The full 13-domain PCI Body of Knowledge (accounting & finance through scheduling, EVM, risk and AI-for-controls), published as a book — PFL-AI and PML-AI editions in production	Free to read for members; honorary members included
MCQs & sample questions	Official sample questions and MCQ practice on Certuvo , PCI's study platform	Sample questions free to all; Certuvo practice per entitlement
Video lectures	Recorded lectures, produced domain by domain (Domain 1 first), plus the webinar library	Members and honorary members as released
Free downloads	Candidate handbook, examination blueprint, master formula sheet, glossary, study guide / course outline, AI-use policy, code of conduct	Everyone — public Downloads Centre
Global chapters	Chapters in 25 countries — US, UK, Europe, Saudi Arabia, UAE, India, Pakistan, Australia, Canada, Singapore, Nigeria, Brazil and more	Everyone
Founding route: free exam	During the founding window, membership and examination fees are waived for the founding cohort — the same real, proctored exam; the credential is still earned by passing it	Founding students (invitation / founding code)
Honorary route	Recognition, verifiable award, certificate — plus the resource stack above	Honorary members — no fees, ever

The two headline bundles (memorise these):

- **Honorary members pay nothing and get:** board-conferred recognition with a publicly verifiable award and certificate + the Simulation Lab and templates library + the books and body of knowledge + MCQs and video lectures + events and webinars + the 25-country chapter community + careers and directory visibility as those surfaces launch.
- **Founding students pay nothing and get:** membership and the **exam fee waived** + the full study stack above (BoK, MCQs, Simulation Lab, lectures, downloads) + recognition as early builders of the standard. The exam is unchanged — nothing is given away except the fee.

Honesty note for copy: access to gated items (Lab, Certuvo, lectures) is controlled by operator-set entitlement flags. Before a campaign promises a specific benefit to a specific group, confirm with operations that the flag is on. "No fees" is always safe; a specific feature promise needs a 30-second check.

Part 4 — Convincing students

Students are the highest-leverage audience: the founding window makes PCI free for them, they share everything, and today's student cohort is the profession's next decade. The pitch is genuinely strong — deliver it in this order:

- 1. Start with the career, not the certificate.** Most students have never heard of project controls — show them the job first: the planner or cost engineer on every airport, metro, energy and data-centre programme, and 25 million project roles opening this decade (Part 2). The site's career-path and salary-guide pages do this for you — link them.
- 2. Then the AI-era angle.** Their generation will work *with* AI from day one. PCI is the only certification that treats governed AI as core to the discipline — that's a first-mover line on any graduate CV.
- 3. Then the price: free.** During the founding window the membership and exam fees are waived. A professional credential attempt at zero cost is an unbeatable student offer — and it's honest: the exam is real and must be passed.
- 4. Then the study stack: also free.** Body of knowledge, sample questions, formula sheet, Simulation Lab practice, video lectures as they release — no textbook bill attached.
- 5. Close with belonging.** Chapters in 25 countries, a community being built in the open, and founding members recognised permanently as early builders — students don't just join, they co-found (Part 8).

Where to reach them: university partnerships (</university-partnerships.html>), student societies (engineering, construction, QS and finance), campus ambassador arrangements, graduate LinkedIn groups, WhatsApp/Telegram student groups, and the career-guide blog content that already ranks for "how to become a planning engineer"-type searches. The free downloads are the lead magnet: give the formula sheet or study guide first, ask for nothing, and let the funnel work.

Part 5 — Techniques per platform

5.1 LinkedIn — the priority channel

This is where project controls professionals, cost engineers, planners and their employers live. Put 70% of the effort here.

A. Set the foundations (week 1)

- Complete the company page: banner, about section (use the Part 1 facts), website link, and the "Enrol" custom button.
- Optimise the personal profile of whoever does outreach: headline mentioning PCI, an About section with the one-liner, the site in the Featured section. People reply to people, not logos.
- Follow and turn on notifications for the top 30 voices in project controls / cost engineering / planning — their comment sections are your audience.

B. Post consistently (every week)

- **Cadence:** 3–4 posts a week from the company page. The ready-made pack in `docs/marketing/linkedin-launch-20-posts.md` covers the first 5–6 weeks.
- **Formats that work, in order:** short text post with one strong image → document/carousel (e.g. "5 signs your CPI is lying", certificate visuals) → poll (great early reach) → short video.
- **Structure every post:** hook line first (the only line people see before "...see more"), teach one concrete thing, one soft CTA, 3–5 hashtags (#ProjectControls #CostEngineering #PlanningEngineer #EarnedValue #ProjectManagement).
- **Announcements are your best content:** every honorary conferral and every newly earned credential is a post — name (with permission), citation, award number, verify link, tag the person. Tagged posts reach their whole network.

C. Engage daily (15 minutes)

- Comment something substantive on 3–5 industry posts every day — comments from the personal profile, replies from the page. This is free distribution.
- Reply to every comment on PCI posts within 24 hours.

D. Connect and DM (the outreach engine — templates in Part 6)

- 20–30 targeted connection requests per week: planners, cost engineers, project controls managers/directors, PMO leads — prioritise the chapter countries (Gulf, UK, US, India, Pakistan, Australia...).
- Sequence: **connection note** (≤300 characters) → after acceptance, **thank-you + short intro DM** → if they engage, the **detailed DM** or an email. Never pitch in the connection note itself, never send the long message first, and stop after one polite follow-up — no spam.
- For distinguished senior figures, use the **honorary invitation** track instead — it opens far more doors than a sales message, because you're offering recognition, not asking for money.

E. Use LinkedIn's free extras

- **LinkedIn Events** for every webinar (attendees get reminders; the event page markets itself).
- **Company newsletter** once the page has some followers — monthly digest, same content as the email newsletter.
- **Polls** monthly ("Which forecast formula does your project trust?") — cheap reach + content ideas from the results.

F. Measure weekly: follower growth, engagement rate per post, DM reply rate, link clicks (use UTM tags: `?utm_source=linkedin&utm_medium=dm`), honorary applications started.

5.2 X / Twitter

Repurpose every LinkedIn post as a short thread the same day. Follow and reply to construction, energy and mega-project commentary. Low effort, keeps the handle alive.

5.3 YouTube

Record every webinar → publish full version + 2–3 one-minute clips (Shorts) with a worked example each. As the domain video lectures release, publish a free sample lecture — it's the best proof of teaching quality. Video titles = search phrases ("What is Earned Value Management?", "Project controls career path").

5.4 Instagram

Visual-only repurposing: quote cards from posts, certificate/badge visuals, chapter photos, 30-second explainer reels. Bio link to the site. Two posts a week is enough.

5.5 WhatsApp & Telegram

Project controls communities in the Gulf, India and Pakistan run on WhatsApp/Telegram groups. Join relevant professional groups, contribute genuinely, and share the short template (6.B1) when someone asks about certifications — never cold-blast a group. A PCI-run broadcast channel for exam windows and webinar dates works well once there's an audience.

5.6 Facebook & Reddit

Facebook groups for planning engineers and Reddit (r/projectmanagement, r/ConstructionManagers) allow discussion, not ads. Answer questions helpfully; mention PCI only where it genuinely answers the question, and disclose you work with PCI. One good answer outperforms ten promo posts.

5.7 Email

- **Newsletter** (signup is on every page of the site): monthly — one teaching piece, one platform update, exam windows, new conferrals.
- **Direct outreach:** templates 6.C — short first, detail on reply. Always a real person's name, always an unsubscribe line for lists.

5.8 The website itself

- Point regional/paid traffic at the matching regional pages (e.g. `/project-controls-certification-saudi-arabia.html`), not the homepage.
- Keep the site-wide **announcement banner** (edited from the admin console, no developer needed) pointed at the current campaign.
- Publish the best-performing LinkedIn posts as blog articles for SEO.
- The site launches in **seven languages** — lead with this in non-English markets; it is a real differentiator against English-only certification bodies.
- **Before any campaign: switch on analytics** — the site has a prepared Plausible/GA4 hook that ships disabled. Without it you can't measure anything.

5.9 Partners

Employers (`/why-employers.html`), universities (`/university-partnerships.html`) and training providers (`/become-a-training-partner.html`) each have a landing page and a template below. One warm partner intro is worth a month of cold DMs — and an honorary conferral to a respected figure inside a target organisation is the warmest intro there is.

Part 6 — The template library

Everything below is copy-paste ready. Personalise [brackets], keep the honesty language intact. Ordered short → long within each group. For answering objections, use the rebuttals in Part 7.

6.A LinkedIn templates

A1. Connection note — general (≤300 characters)

Use when: connecting with any project controls professional.

Hi [Name] — I work with the Project Controls Institute, a new non-profit body building a certification standard for project controls in the AI era. Your work at [Company] caught my eye. Would be glad to connect.

A2. Connection note — senior figure / honorary prospect (≤300 characters)

Use when: connecting with a distinguished practitioner you may later invite to apply for Honorary Fellow.

Hi [Name] — I'm with the Project Controls Institute. Your contribution to [specific thing — book, standard, community, major programme] is exactly the kind of work our institute exists to recognise. I'd be glad to connect.

A3. First DM after they accept — short intro

Use when: they accepted; keep it light, no links yet unless natural.

Thanks for connecting, [Name]. Quick intro so this isn't a mystery: PCI is an independent non-profit institute certifying project controls, cost engineering and project finance — with the governed use of AI treated as part of the discipline. We're building it in the open, honest about status, everything publicly verifiable. If you're ever curious it's all at projectcontrolsinstitute.org — and I'm happy to answer anything. Either way, glad to have you in the network.

A4. DM — the platform explained (medium)

Use when: they replied, asked a question, or engaged with a post.

Happy to give you the full picture, [Name].

PCI (Project Controls Institute) is an independent, non-profit certifying body founded on a simple observation: project controls has never had a focused professional standard of its own — and AI is changing the work faster than any existing credential covers.

What we offer:

- Three certifications — PCL-AI (project controls), PFL-AI (project finance), PML-AI (project management) — scenario-based, properly proctored exams, framework developed with reference to ISO/IEC 17024.
- A serious free study stack — the full body of knowledge, sample questions, a Simulation Lab with real planning and cost scenarios, video lectures as they release.
- Membership with CPD tracking, chapters in 25 countries, and a platform launching in seven languages.
- Everything verifiable: any credential can be checked by anyone at projectcontrolsinstitute.org/verify.html.

One honest note, because it's how we operate: we're building toward formal accreditation and say so plainly — we never claim recognition we don't yet hold.

If you'd like to look, start here: projectcontrolsinstitute.org/why-pci.html. Any questions, just ask.

A5. DM — honorary invitation

Use when: inviting a distinguished practitioner to apply. This is the highest-value message — send it sparingly and personalise heavily.

[Name], I'll be direct about why I'm writing.

The board of the Project Controls Institute confers a small number of Honorary Fellow (PCI) recognitions on practitioners whose contribution to the profession genuinely merits it. Given your [specific contribution — be precise], I'd like to invite you to put yourself forward for the board's consideration.

What it involves: a ten-minute application and a CV — that's it. There is no fee. Not to apply, not if conferred, not ever.

If the board confers it, you receive a registered award (publicly verifiable at any time), a certificate, and free access to the institute's resources — the body of knowledge and books, the Simulation Lab, lectures and webinars — plus its events and professional community.

One honest note: this is honorary recognition of contribution. It's separate from PCI's examined certifications, which are only ever earned by examination — we keep that line absolute.

The application is here: projectcontrolsinstitute.org/honorary-application.html — and I'm happy to answer any questions first.

A6. DM — student pitch

Use when: messaging students, recent graduates, or student-society contacts.

Hi [Name] — since you're [studying engineering / heading into construction / finishing your degree], this might genuinely be worth two minutes.

Project controls — the planners and cost engineers on every airport, metro and energy programme — is one of the most under-supplied professions this decade (PMI puts the gap at 25 million project roles by 2030). PCI is a new non-profit institute certifying exactly that, with AI skills built into the standard.

The student-relevant part: during the founding window, membership and the exam fee are waived — and the study stack is free too: the full body of knowledge, sample questions, a Simulation Lab to practise real scenarios, and video lectures as they release. The exam is real and has to be passed — that's the point; it's a credential, not a participation certificate.

Start here if you're curious: projectcontrolsinstitute.org/candidate-journey.html

A7. Follow-up DM (one only, ~1 week later)

Use when: no reply to A4, A5 or A6. After this, stop.

Hi [Name] — just floating this back up once in case it got buried. No pressure at all; if the timing's wrong, all good. The short version: [one line — e.g. "free, board-conferred recognition with a verifiable award — ten-minute application"]. Here if useful.

6.B WhatsApp / short text templates

B1. Shortest version (any chat)

Have you seen the Project Controls Institute? New non-profit certification body for project controls / cost engineering, with AI governance built into the standard. Free resources on the site and every credential is publicly verifiable → projectcontrolsinstitute.org

B2. Honorary short version

Worth knowing about: PCI (Project Controls Institute) confers an Honorary Fellow recognition for people with real contribution to the profession — no exam, no fees at all, and the award is publicly verifiable. 10-minute application:

projectcontrolsinstitute.org/honorary-application.html

B3. Student short version

If you're a student heading toward construction/energy/infrastructure: PCI (Project Controls Institute) is certifying project controls — huge talent gap, AI-era skills — and during the founding window the exam fee is waived. Free body of knowledge + practice lab on the site → projectcontrolsinstitute.org

6.C Email templates

C1. Cold email — short intro

Use when: first contact. Subject: "A professional standard for project controls".

Dear [Name],

I'm [Your name] from the Project Controls Institute (PCI) — an independent, non-profit body building a focused certification standard for project controls, cost engineering and project finance in the AI era.

Given your role at [Company], I thought it worth one short email. In brief: three scenario-based certifications (PCL-AI, PFL-AI, PML-AI), chapters in 25 countries, a large free resource stack, and every credential publicly verifiable at any time.

If that's of interest, the best two-minute overview is here: projectcontrolsinstitute.org/why-pci.html

Happy to answer any questions.

Best regards,

[Your name] · Project Controls Institute · hello@projectcontrolsinstitute.org

C2. Email — the platform in full detail (long)

Use when: they replied with interest, or a warm contact asked "so what exactly is PCI?" Subject: "PCI in detail — as promised".

Dear [Name],

Thank you for the interest — here's the full picture, honestly told.

Who we are. The Project Controls Institute (PCI) is an independent, non-profit certifying body founded in 2025. Our position is simple: project controls — the integrated discipline of planning, cost, risk, forecasting, contracts and project finance — has long lacked a focused professional standard of its own, and AI is transforming the work. AI can draft the schedule and the forecast; the professional must know whether to trust it. Our slogan says it in six words: *"AI proposes. The professional disposes."*

The certifications. PCI awards the AI Project Leadership Certification Suite:

- **PCL-AI** — PCI AI Project Controls Leader
- **PFL-AI** — PCI AI Project Finance Leader
- **PML-AI** — PCI Project Management Leader – AI

The examinations are scenario-based and delivered under proper proctoring through a secure exam system; MCQ preparation runs on Certuvo, PCI's official study platform, and applied practice in the PCI Simulation Lab. The certification framework is developed with reference to ISO/IEC 17024, the international standard for bodies certifying persons.

The learning stack. A published 13-domain Body of Knowledge (from accounting and cost management through scheduling, earned value, risk and AI-for-controls) available as a book, with further editions in production; official sample questions; a master formula sheet, candidate handbook and study guide free in the Downloads Centre; video lectures releasing domain by domain; and a Simulation Lab where candidates practise real planning and cost scenarios with a free templates library.

Membership and community. Membership grades run from Student through Professional to Fellow, with CPD tracking, a professional directory and chapters in 25 countries. The platform launches in seven languages — English, Arabic, Chinese, French, Korean, Russian and Spanish.

Three ways in.

1. **Standard** — enrol, study, sit the exam (current fees are on the membership page).
2. **Founding** — during the founding window, membership and examination fees are waived; the exam is unchanged and the credential is still earned by passing it.
3. **Honorary** — for distinguished contribution to the profession, the board confers **Honorary Fellow (PCI)**: no exam, and no fees of any kind. It comes with a registered, verifiable award, a certificate, and free access to the resources, events and community. It is always labelled honorary — it is never the examined certification.

Verification. Every credential and honorary award can be checked by anyone, at any time, at projectcontrolsinstitute.org/verify.html. We think a claim you can't verify is worth very little.

Our honest position. PCI is building toward formal accreditation and toward non-profit tax-exempt recognition, and we state plainly that neither is held yet. We never guarantee jobs, salaries or third-party recognition. For a certification body, trust is the entire product — so we'd rather understate than oversell.

If you'd like to go further: [choose one — enrolment: projectcontrolsinstitute.org/enrol.html / honorary application: projectcontrolsinstitute.org/honorary-application.html / a call this week].

With best regards,

[Your name] · Project Controls Institute · hello@projectcontrolsinstitute.org

C3. Email — honorary invitation (long)

Use when: formally inviting a senior figure. Subject: "An invitation — Honorary Fellow of the Project Controls Institute".

Dear [Name],

I'm writing on behalf of the Project Controls Institute (PCI), an independent non-profit certifying body for project controls, cost engineering and project finance.

Each year the institute's board confers a small number of **Honorary Fellow (PCI)** recognitions on individuals whose sustained contribution to the profession merits it. Your [specific contribution — publications, standards work, programme leadership, mentoring at scale], is precisely the kind of contribution this recognition exists for, and I would like to invite you to put yourself forward for the board's consideration.

What it involves. A short application (about ten minutes) with your CV at projectcontrolsinstitute.org/honorary-application.html. You receive a reference immediately, and the board reviews every application personally. **There is no fee at any stage — not to apply, not if conferred, and nothing recurring afterwards.**

What conferral brings.

- The designation Honorary Fellow (PCI), conferred with a citation

- A registered award number, publicly verifiable by anyone at any time
- A certificate issued by the institute
- Free access to PCI's resources — the body of knowledge and books, the Simulation Lab and templates, lectures, webinars and events
- Membership of a growing global community, with chapters in 25 countries

In fairness, two honest notes. Conferral is at the board's discretion — an invitation to apply is not a promise of the outcome. And Honorary Fellow (PCI) is a recognition of contribution: it is deliberately separate from PCI's examined certifications, which are only ever earned by examination. We keep that distinction absolute, because it protects the value of both.

I would be delighted to answer any questions before you decide.

With respect and best regards,

[Your name] · Project Controls Institute · hello@projectcontrolsinstitute.org

C4. Email — employer / corporate (medium)

Use when: writing to HR, PMO or capability leads. Subject: "A consistent standard for project-controls capability".

Dear [Name],

When you hire a planner or cost engineer, how do you know what you're getting? Most organisations answer with interviews and hope — because project controls has never had a single, verifiable standard.

The Project Controls Institute (PCI) is an independent non-profit building exactly that: a certification suite covering project controls, cost engineering and project finance, with the governed use of AI treated as part of the discipline. Scenario-based proctored examinations, a published body of knowledge, and — importantly for employers — **every credential publicly verifiable in seconds** at projectcontrolsinstitute.org/verify.html.

For teams, that means a shared capability language across projects and regions, and a development pathway your controls staff can see. Corporate programmes are here: projectcontrolsinstitute.org/corporate-programs.html

Would a 20-minute call be useful? I'm happy to walk through how other [sector] organisations are approaching it.

Best regards,

[Your name] · Project Controls Institute

C5. Email — university / training provider (medium)

Use when: academic programme leads or training companies. Subject: "Partnering on the project-controls standard".

Dear [Name],

The Project Controls Institute (PCI) is an independent non-profit certifying body for project controls, cost engineering and project finance — with a published body of knowledge and a certification suite (PCL-AI, PFL-AI, PML-AI) developed with reference to ISO/IEC 17024.

We partner with [universities: projectcontrolsinstitute.org/university-partnerships.html / training providers: projectcontrolsinstitute.org/become-a-training-partner.html] to connect programmes like yours at [Institution] to a recognised professional pathway: students and delegates study against the PCI body of knowledge — free to access, with sample questions, a practice Simulation Lab and video lectures — and graduates leave with a route to a verifiable professional credential. During the current founding window, that route is fee-waived for students.

If a conversation would be useful, I'd be glad to set one up.

Best regards,

[Your name] · Project Controls Institute

C6. Follow-up email (one only, ~1 week later)

Dear [Name],

A brief follow-up on my note below — I know inboxes are unforgiving. If it's not for you or not for now, no reply needed and I won't chase again. If it is, the one link worth a look is: [single most relevant link].

Best regards,

[Your name]

6.D Post templates (LinkedIn / newsletter)

D1. Honorary conferral announcement

The board of the Project Controls Institute has conferred **Honorary Fellow (PCI)** on [Name], in recognition of [citation — one concrete sentence].

Honorary Fellow (PCI) is a board-conferred recognition of distinguished contribution to the profession — no examination, and distinct from PCI's examined certifications.

Award [PCI-HON-YYYY-NNNN] · verifiable any time at projectcontrolsinstitute.org/verify.html

Congratulations, [Name]. [Tag them.]

#ProjectControls #CostEngineering #ProjectManagement

D2. "What is PCI" post (personal voice)

People keep asking what the Project Controls Institute actually is, so — plainly:

An independent, non-profit certification body for project controls, cost engineering and project finance. Three scenario-based certifications (PCL-AI, PFL-AI, PML-AI). A body of knowledge you can read. Proctored exams you can't shortcut. Credentials anyone can verify online, any time.

And one thing we don't do: overclaim. We're building toward accreditation and we say exactly where we are. In a market full of certificate mills, we think honesty is the differentiator.

Start here: projectcontrolsinstitute.org/why-pci.html

#ProjectControls #CostEngineering #PlanningEngineer

D3. Honorary route awareness post

Some people have already given this profession more than any exam could measure.

That's what the honorary route is for. The Project Controls Institute board confers **Honorary Fellow (PCI)** on practitioners of distinguished contribution — no examination, **no fees of any kind**, and a registered award anyone can verify online.

It's not our examined certification and it never pretends to be. It's recognition — real, registered and free.

Apply for the board's consideration: projectcontrolsinstitute.org/honorary-application.html

#ProjectControls #CostEngineering #ProjectManagement

D4. Student-facing post

To every engineering student wondering what job actually runs the world's mega-projects:

It's project controls. The planners, cost engineers and risk analysts behind every airport, metro, energy and data-centre programme — and PMI estimates the world needs 25 million new project professionals by 2030.

The Project Controls Institute is building the professional standard for that career, with AI skills at the core — and while the founding window is open, students can take the route to a real, proctored, verifiable credential with the fees waived. The body of knowledge, sample questions and practice lab are free.

Career path first, certificate second: projectcontrolsinstitute.org/candidate-journey.html

#ProjectControls #EngineeringStudents #GraduateJobs #ConstructionCareers

Part 7 — Objection handling: the rebuttal library

The approved answer to every hard question. Learn the pattern: **agree with the concern, answer with a fact, point at proof**. Never get defensive — the honest answer *is* the sales pitch.

"Is PCI accredited?"

Honest answer: not yet, and we won't pretend otherwise. The framework is developed with reference to ISO/IEC 17024 and we're building toward formal accreditation — the site states our exact status at projectcontrolsinstitute.org/accreditation-status.html. We'd rather earn trust by being straight about this than claim something we don't hold.

"Nobody's heard of PCI — will employers accept it?"

Fair — every standard started unknown; recognition is earned, not declared. What an employer can do with PCI *today*: read the published body of knowledge, see the exam blueprint, and verify any credential in seconds. That's more transparency than most established credentials offer. And we never claim acceptance we haven't earned — recognition varies by employer and that's stated plainly on the site.

"How is this different from PMP or AACE?"

We don't claim equivalence with anyone. The difference in scope: PCI certifies the whole controls discipline as one integrated capability — planning, cost, risk, finance — with governed AI use treated as core, not an add-on. Comparison page:

projectcontrolsinstitute.org/pmp-vs-aace-vs-pcl-ai.html.

"My employer only funds PMP/AACE."

Understandable — funding follows familiarity. Two answers: the founding window means PCI may cost you nothing anyway; and the credentials aren't substitutes — PCI certifies the integrated controls-plus-AI capability the others don't cover. Many candidates hold both.

"What does it cost?"

The standard route: membership plus the exam fee (current prices are on projectcontrolsinstitute.org/membership.html — there are launch discounts running). Founding students: fees waived while the window is open. The honorary route costs nothing at all — no application, conferral or renewal fees.

"Free? What's the catch?"

There isn't one, and here's the logic: PCI is a non-profit building a professional community from zero. The founding cohort and honorary fellows are the people who give the standard life — waiving their fees is an investment in the profession, not a loss-leader trick. Note what is *not* free: the exam still has to be passed. Nothing about the assessment is discounted.

"Is this a certificate mill?"

The opposite — check the mechanics. Proctored, scenario-based exams in a locked-down client; a published 13-domain body of knowledge; results that can be withheld on integrity review; public verification of every credential; and an honorary route that is explicitly labelled honorary and can never convert into the examined credential. Mills don't build any of that.

"Isn't Honorary Fellow just a free title giveaway?"

No — three safeguards. It's conferred by the board at its discretion, application is not conferral. It's registered and publicly verifiable, so it can't be quietly inflated. And it's permanently labelled honorary — it never becomes, or is presented as, the examined certification. It recognises contribution already made; it doesn't certify competence.

"AI will do these jobs anyway — why certify?"

AI is exactly why. The tools now draft the schedule and the forecast — which moves the human job up a level: validating assumptions, catching the model's errors, owning the decision. That judgment layer is what PCI certifies, and no legacy credential covers it. "AI proposes. The professional disposes."

"I don't have time to study."

The stack is built for working professionals: the body of knowledge is free to read, sample questions and a formula sheet are downloadable, lectures release domain by domain, and the Simulation Lab lets you practise in short, graded scenarios rather than marathon reading. Start with one domain.

"The platform is brand new — what if it disappears?"

A fair risk question. PCI is a registered non-profit corporation building in public — published governance, published policies, an open changelog of what's in place versus in progress. And your credential's proof doesn't live in a PDF: it's in a public registry, verifiable independently of any conversation with us.

"I'm a student — I can't afford certification."

During the founding window you may not need to: membership and exam fees are waived for the founding cohort. The learning stack — body of knowledge, sample questions, study guide, practice lab — is free regardless. The only thing you can't skip is passing the exam.

"How do I check someone's PCI credential?"

Anyone can, free, in seconds: projectcontrols.institute.org/verify.html — enter the credential or award number.

Part 8 — Building it together: students and honorary members as co-builders

The mission behind every campaign: **PCI is not selling to students and honorary members — it is recruiting them to build a world-class professional platform.** The people the institute serves are the people who make it credible. Say this openly; it's true and it converts better than any discount.

Why this framing works: "help us build the standard" gives people ownership, identity and a story to tell — three things "buy our certificate" never does. Founding members are permanently recognised as early builders; honorary fellows lend the standing they've already earned. Both groups become the platform's most credible marketers, unpaid and unprompted.

What students are invited to build:

- Be the founding cohort — the first names through a fee-waived route to a real credential.
- Feed back on every course, lab scenario and lecture as it releases — the product improves around them.
- Start and staff campus chapters; become the ambassador who brought PCI to their university.

- Grow with the platform: today's founding student is next decade's Professional, examiner, chapter lead and Fellow.

What honorary members are invited to build:

- Review and strengthen body-of-knowledge domains in their specialism.
- Give guest lectures and webinars; mentor candidates.
- Lead and grow the 25 country chapters.
- Contribute to standards consultations — and lend their name to a standard being built properly.

The community infrastructure exists — forum, community rooms, contributor desk — launching in phases behind operator controls, with resource access scorable to honorary members and every contribution recognised. Confirm a surface is live before promising it in copy.

The co-builder blurb (use anywhere):

PCI is being built in the open — and it's being built *with* the people it serves. Founding students take the first fee-waived route through a real exam and are recognised permanently as early builders. Honorary Fellows bring the experience the standard is built on. If you want a certificate, plenty of bodies will sell you one. If you want to help build the professional home this discipline never had — in seven languages, across 25 countries — this is it.

Part 9 — Do / Don't (the guardrails)

Do say: developed with reference to ISO/IEC 17024 · building toward accreditation · independent non-profit institute · publicly verifiable · free, board-conferred honorary recognition · no fees on the honorary route · fee-waived founding window (exam still required) · cited third-party market figures (PMI, BLS, Oxford Economics).

Never say: accredited / ISO-certified / government-recognised · 501(c)(3) or tax-deductible · guaranteed jobs, salary or recognition by employers · market figures without naming the source · anything implying Honorary Fellow is a certification or a waived exam · guaranteed conferral ("apply and you'll receive...") · a specific gated benefit for a specific group without checking the entitlement flag is on (Part 3).

Behaviour: one follow-up maximum, then stop · never blast groups or buy lists · get permission before naming an awardee in a post · when unsure, use the site footer's own wording — it's the approved formulation.